

low as the Realme 11 Pro while the other competitors blew past it. The same thing was reflected in real-world gaming as well. In Call of Duty: Mobile, I booted the game at High graphics but I was still facing some frame drops. Overall, this is not the best phone under ₹25,000 for power users and gamers. Multitasking and basic day-to-day tasks work well, but I wouldn't call it a particularly powerful device.

As for the software, you've got Android 13 with Moto's MyUX skin on top. As we've seen before, this skin is pretty light on bloatware. There are also a few Google and Moto apps in the mix, but no games,

quite a long time to shoot and unless your hands are completely still, you're almost always going to end up with a shaky or blurry shot. Pictures from the primary camera look amazing in daylight though. I clicked some sharp, detailed-looking shots when there was adequate lighting, however, the dynamic range – while decent – is not perfect. But honestly, I'm nitpicking here given the Edge 40 Neo's affordable price tag.

Portraits also look amazing with almost flawless edge detection. Skin tones look pretty natural as well, and the detail retention is good for the price.

minutes until the battery died out. This is consistent enough with the battery performance of other competitors such as the Infinix Zero 30, iQOO Z7 Pro, and Realme 11 Pro. So, the battery life is nothing extraordinary but it doesn't fall short either.

Most users should comfortably get through a day's worth of usage, and if you're a light user, you may even squeeze out a day and a half worth of battery. The 68 W charging is quite speedy – the phone charges up to full in just under an hour, which is pretty decent. Also, the charger is provided in the box, which is something I'm having to mention more than I'd like to these days.

VERDICT

So, the question is – does the Motorola Edge 40 Neo recreate the magic of the Moto Edge 40 in the sub-₹25,000 price segment? The answer to that is quite a resounding yes. It shines in the same areas the Moto Edge 40 did and it manages to do that on a tighter budget. The phone has one of the cleanest UIs on the market, a stylish and premium design, a bright and fluid display, and fast charging. What it lacks is the performance chops that some of the latest sub ₹25K phones serve up in spades. You won't have the smoothest gaming experience but if you can live with that, the Motorola Edge 40 Neo is a winner. The ₹23,999 price point is a pretty sweet spot but as part of an introductory discount offer, you can even grab the phone for as low as ₹20,999.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7030 (6 nm) | RAM + Storage: 8 GB LPDDR4X + 128 GB UFS 2.2 | 12 GB LPDDR4X + 256 GB UFS 2.2 | Display: 6.55-inch pOLED, 144 Hz, HDR10+ | Battery: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 68 W fast charging | IP rating: IP68 | Cameras (rear): 50 MP OIS + 13 MP ultrawide & macro | Selfie camera: 32 MP | Video (rear and front): Up to 4K at 30 fps | Speakers: Dual stereo speakers, Dolby Atmos | OS: Android 13

CONTACT

Company: Motorola | Phone: N/A | Email: Web form | Website: <https://www.motorola.in/>



Boo-Man's thoughts

"Well, the Moto Edge 40 Neo is like trying to recreate a classic dish with cheaper ingredients - it looks good and serves the basics, but it's missing that high-end flavor you'd expect. You'll get a snazzy design and some decent features, but don't expect it to compete with the big players in the mid-range arena."

or other third-party applications, which is amazing. The company is providing guaranteed upgrades to Android 14 and Android 15 as well as three years of security updates – which is decent, but not the best.

CAMERA

On paper, the Motorola Edge 40 Neo has a camera setup that's very similar to the Moto Edge 40. However, the aperture of the primary camera is f/1.8, which is narrower than the f/1.4 aperture on the Moto Edge 40.

So, naturally, the camera isn't able to let in as much light as the 50 MP shooter on the Moto Edge 40 and this is apparent when you click pictures in low light. They aren't as detailed and noise-free as the Moto Edge 40. Additionally, the Night Mode pictures take

Ultrawide photos from the 13 MP camera are not bad; the colours are consistent, but the shadows do lack some detail. You can also click macro pictures through this camera and they look pretty impressive! As for selfies, the phone does well here. The skin tone depiction could be better, but at least the detail and dynamic range are pretty sound.

BATTERY LIFE

The Motorola Edge 40 Neo's battery life is average for the price. I tested the battery with the phone's refresh rate set on Auto Mode, so naturally, if you opt for 144 Hz, your mileage will differ – probably drastically.

In our 4K video loop test, which we do on every phone we review, the Motorola Edge 40 lasted 14 hours and 35